

CHAPTER 11

NUTRITION IN HYPERTENSION AND CARDIO-VASCULAR DISEASE

OBJECTIVES

This chapter will enable students to

- Know about factors that contribute to hypertension
- explain the relationship between sodium and hypertension
- identify foods that are limited or avoided in sodium-restricted diets
- list the risk factors for cardiovascular conditions
- identify foods to avoid or limit in Cardiovascular Disease

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Hypertension or high blood pressure is one of the risk factors for Cardiovascular Diseases **(CVD)**. Treating high blood pressure significantly decreases the risk of stroke, myocardial infarction and cardiovascular death. Lifestyle modification can have a significant protective effect as well. This chapter will give an overview of the causes, symptoms and complications of hypertension and CVD as well as the role of food in the prevention and management of the same.

11.1 HYPERTENSION

Blood pressure is a measurement of the force exerted by the blood upon the walls of the blood vessels as it flows through it. It is measured using a **sphygmomanometer** and the reading is expressed as systolic blood pressure **(SBP)** / diastolic blood pressure **(DBP)** in mm Hg. Normal blood pressure is **120/80 mm Hg**.

Hypertension is a condition that results because of chronically elevated blood pressure. It is referred to as the **"silent killer"** because it may not cause any symptoms initially. Hypertension may lead to other complications such as heart attack, stroke, heart failure, and kidney failure.

Blood pressure categories given by the American College of Cardiology and the American Heart Association (ACC/AHA, 2017) are as follows: